## AUTHOR'S NOTE

Unlike the American CIA, British MI6 and Israel's espionage unit Mossad, the Indian intelligence community guards its critical operations, achievements and failures vigilantly. This book is an attempt to clear away the cobwebs. It is based on numerous conversations with intelligence operatives and spymasters. Declassified documents —exclusively accessed—have also helped in putting together lives of agents, assets and the history of India's external spy organisation, Research & Analysis Wing (R&AW). Many quotations and perspectives mentioned in this book are attributed to the source notes. If any attribution is missing, it is primarily to ensure anonymity. I have offered cover names to assets, agents and locations in certain missions for the sake of national security and to talk about the unsung heroes albeit, in the iron mask. However, the story remains close to the truth. Upholding the country's security and effectively countering the shadowy war of numerous forces is hardwired into R&AW's DNA. The narratives in this compilation are, in some sense, milestones of India's espionage history that needed to be told so that informationrich, global community comes to understand the 'mission impossible' attempted at different times and in difficult situations by Indian spies. The author is grateful to the men and women of the Indian intelligence community for letting him peek into the working of India's designated covert society that made this book possible.

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## PROLOGUE